

A Review of Reproductive Rights Under the Trump Administration

In the summer of 2022, the Supreme Court's ruling in *Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization* overturned its landmark decision in *Roe v. Wade* and *Casey v. Planned Parenthood*, both of which, decades prior, secured the federal right to abortion. This action transferred the judgment of abortion laws to the states, effectively shutting down 66 abortion clinics across the United States within nearly three months of the ruling. Unfortunately, the 2024 election of the Republican Party leader, Donald Trump, has further intensified the American people's access to sexual and reproductive healthcare. Within the first 100 days of the Trump administration, stricter and more conservative acts have seeped into the remaining branches of abortion clinics and laws. Eight months later, and not even a year into his presidency, Trump has continued his attempts to extinguish the reproductive rights of millions of Americans.

Freezing and Cutting Funds from Welfare

Limiting funding to federal welfare programs concerning reproductive healthcare is one immediate action with harsh consequences that the Trump administration has undertaken. In March of 2025, the government notified 16 out of 76 Title X grantees that their funding would be temporarily restricted. Title X, a law that protects against sex-based discrimination, is also the only federal program that provides crucial family planning and preventive care, particularly to low-income, marginalized communities. It covers a range of reproductive healthcare, including birth control, sexually transmitted infection precautions, infertility resources, and breast and cervical cancer screenings. However, the funding freeze has significantly affected the scope of this welfare program's impact by reducing staff numbers within the Department of Health and Human Services. Since Trump was sworn into office, the department has experienced a 24.4% decrease in its workforce, dwindling from 82,000 to 62,000 employees. Specific organizations within the family planning network, structured by Title X, have also limited their services due to employee dismissals, including Planned Parenthood clinics and other health centers.

Additionally, when Trump signed the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA) into law in July, he stripped millions of funding from Medicaid and the Affordable Care Act. These welfare programs were established by President Lyndon B. Johnson in 1965 and President Barack Obama in 2010, respectively, to expand access to health insurance and comprehensive healthcare. These historic cuts have devastated health insurance coverage for millions of

Americans, especially women, who make up over half the total number of individuals in the Medicaid program at 52%. Similar to the Title X freeze, OBBBA also withholds financial aid to Planned Parenthood, further limiting women's access to safe and affordable reproductive medical services. At this rate, the federal government's changing role in restraining universal healthcare, with emphasis on reproductive care, has and will continue to restrict impoverished Americans from receiving vital treatments.



Caption: The photo above shows Trump signing the One Big Beautiful Bill Act into law, which cut millions of dollars in funding from welfare programs regarding healthcare.

From The Interpreter.

Godara, Shameek. "Trump's Big Beautiful Bill: A domestic deal with Indo-Pacific consequences." The Lowy Institute, 21 July 2025,

<https://www.lowyinstitute.org/the-interpreter/trump-s-big-beautiful-bill-domestic-deal-indo-pacific-consequences>

Diminishing Research and Public Access to Information

Despite his self-proclaimed title of the “fertilization president,” Trump has strived to eliminate federal funding for reproductive health research. In addition to nearly dismantling public health programs, the administration has purged the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, resulting in the layoff of over 2,000 employees, including most from the Division of Reproductive Health. Along with the staff cuts within this division, which promotes information regarding women’s fertility, mothers, and infants, Trump has terminated several research teams as well. Among these are the Assisted Reproductive Technology (ART) Surveillance team and another group of medical investigators who publicize updates on the most effective contraceptives.

Additionally, almost immediately after he was sworn into office, Trump wiped government-distributed information on women’s health services and abortion care from all internet search engines. ReproductiveRights.gov, a website founded by the Biden Administration that provided the public with reproductive health information, was rendered a blank domain, and the page refused to load when users clicked on it. Mentions of federal protection for abortion care and fertility privacy were backspaced on the Department of Health and Human Services website. As a result, the administration’s resolution to ignore the need to protect clinics has restricted the public from safely accessing sexual healthcare.

The current administration has also lessened its enforcement of the Freedom of Access to Clinic Entrances (FACE) Act, which protected patients and providers within reproductive healthcare from extremists and harassment. Moreover, the administration has taken measures against ordinary citizens who defy its new policies by criminalizing doctors who perform illegal procedures and threatening lawyers who attempt to defend their clients’ civil rights. As a result, individuals in need of family planning services must risk their safety, and those seeking emergency operations are placed in critical conditions, sometimes even leading to death.



Caption: The photo above depicts the sign of the CDC headquarters located in Atlanta, GA, whose staffing was cut by the Department of Health and Human Services.

From Kaiser Health News

Pradham, Rachana. "HHS eliminates CDC staff who made sure birth control is safe for women at risk." Tucson Sentinel, 1 July 2025,
https://www.tucsonsentinel.com/nationworld/report/070125_cdc_reproductive_health/hhs-eliminates-cdc-staff-who-made-sure-birth-control-safe-women-risk/

Responses from Women and Activists Nationwide

Naturally, Trump's impositions have sparked outrage among women and activists across the nation. Established activist groups such as the American Civil Liberties Union and the Human Rights Watch have condemned Trump's abortion policies, with the latter calling them "frightening." Nonprofits such as Reproductive Freedom for All and Women's March have taken action to organize protests and other activities to challenge the administration's new stance on

reproductive healthcare. On April 5, Reproductive Freedom for All organized a nationwide mass protest titled “Hands Off! Our Bodies.” This movement aimed to resist the GOP’s Project 2025 plan, which the nonprofit demonized as a “Trump-Musk Power Grab.”

On the other hand, Women’s March has mobilized its forces to support nationwide demonstrations, such as the 50501 Movement, which promoted resistance against the Trump administration. The “Kick Out the Clowns” event on July 14th was a response to Trump’s extravagant military parade, with attendees showing up to protests across America in full clown attire and other festivities. Other activities included the Rally for Patient Rights, where the Women’s March aligned with Planned Parenthood to fight for the preservation of Medicaid; supporting Free America, a demonstration featuring picnics and parades; and Save Our Healthcare, where protesters marched into the federal Senate building to defend healthcare rights. The efforts of activist groups, such as those mentioned, reflect traditional American ideals of democracy and demonstrate the people’s power when their voices are not adequately represented in government.



Caption: The photo above shows protestors gathered at the Wisconsin State Capitol in light of the “Kick Out the Clowns” demonstration held by Women’s March.

From WORT 89.9FM

8 O’Clock Buzz and Brian Standing. “Thousands Rally to ‘Kick Out the Clowns.’” 8 O’Clock Buzz, 16 June 2025, <https://www.wortfm.org/thousands-rally-to-kick-out-the-clowns/>

Voices of Mississippian Women: An Interview with IAJE

As a Mississippi native, I witnessed the direct effects of the *Dobbs* case, which began with the immediate closure of the Jackson Women’s Health Organization facility. Located in the bustling shopping center of Fondren, the bright pink building, a symbol of resistance against Mississippi’s attempts to restrict abortion, was sheathed with heavy black boards for remodeling. Three years later, while Mississippi no longer provides safe access to reproductive healthcare, abortion activists are still pushing for representation. I reached out to an activist group based in Jackson to gain insight into how Mississippian women have withstood the effects of the Trump administration.

The Immigrant Alliance for Justice and Equity of Mississippi (IAJE; pronounced ‘yah-hey’) is a grassroots activism organization with a network that extends across Mississippi. Founded in 2019 in response to the increasing number of ICE raids in Mississippi, this group comprises individuals from diverse ethnicities, nationalities, and age groups. While IAJE primarily focuses on immigration policy issues (most of its members identify as immigrants or children of immigrants), it also addresses other systemic problems, including LGBTQ+ and reproductive rights. My interview request to IAJE was approved by Crystal Lopez, a student at Jackson State University pursuing a bachelor’s degree in public health. On the day of the interview, I drove to meet her at IAJE’s office, which she had invited me to tour. Immediately stepping into the building, I felt a sense of whiplash from the contrast between IAJE’s warm, inviting atmosphere and the barren, faded roads of west downtown Jackson. Colorful posters featuring powerful symbols of human rights and social justice, in English and Spanish, adorned the walls. Ms. Lopez led me through a corridor lined with positive and empowering messages and into a meeting room to begin our interview.

She introduced herself as a youth organizer and public health fellow at IAJE, where her primary duties include engaging youth in civic engagement and leading the *promotoras de salud* (health promoters), a public health cohort of community health workers. Within this cohort, Ms. Lopez educates the members, comprising individuals from every part of Mississippi, on preventive healthcare. She also explained IAJE’s activities to me, which include a variety of community-based initiatives, such as cultural events featuring art, faith-based groups, life skills workshops, and collaborations with other local activist groups for peaceful protests.

When *Roe v Wade* was overturned in 2022, IAJE released a statement condemning the Supreme Court's decision and spread translations of the news to individuals who were not proficient in English. Regarding IAJE's current activities and plans related to reproductive justice, Ms. Lopez described changes to the curriculum of the upcoming public health cohort, scheduled to begin in November. The organization is determined to place more emphasis on teaching reproductive healthcare after the Mississippi State Department of Health recently declared increasing infant mortality rates a public health emergency. The organization is also currently planning a campaign to promote breastfeeding education and other reproductive health information. Before each initiative, she explains, IAJE takes careful measures to research public health crises and consults with its legal team. "At IAJE, we believe reproductive justice and abortion are something that everyone should have access to."

Additionally, Ms. Lopez expressed her opinion on the significance of the *Dobbs* decision in Mississippi. "I think one of the reasons why the [infant] mortality cases are rising is because of that [decision]," she said. She also expressed IAJE's frustration at the idea of women giving birth against their will, even if it would jeopardize the woman's physical health or her financial situation. "In Mississippi, no one's really teaching sex-ed," she said as she discussed how the effects of the state's near-complete ban on abortion directly target low-income women, who are disproportionately uneducated in reproductive health. Furthermore, she argues that restricting women from accessing aid for sexual health does not prevent them from seeking it; instead, the restrictions push women to endanger themselves as they look for unsafe alternatives. "Not only do you already feel very neglected in the healthcare field in Mississippi," she said, "but having this overturn just makes things worse."

Finally, I asked Ms. Lopez what the *Dobbs* decision meant from her perspective. "There were no words for me to describe how I felt," she said, shaking her head, "because I felt like we had just taken so many years back of all we've been fighting for, not even just reproductive justice, but rights when it comes to being a woman." As someone who has always stood on the side of pro-choice, she felt like she and millions of other American women had been unfairly stripped of their autonomy. She then reiterated her stance on how abortion bans propel women to search for other high-risk procedures, believing that there should be broader efforts to promote fertility and family planning education. At the end of our meeting, Ms. Lopez gave me a tour of IJAE's small but cozy environment, showing me where the different divisions within the organization operated. As I drove home from Jackson, I felt a sense of awe at the reformative work of a small but mighty community within that red-brick building and its striking mural.

Once a single demographic's liberties are restrained, it does not take long before others face similar challenges. Although the devastating policies of the current administration have impacted

millions of individuals across America and threatened the collapse of democracy, a collaboration of immediate action from coast to coast can prevent the complete annihilation of our civil rights. Simple acts of advocacy, such as calling your senator or signing a petition, can cultivate a highly functional form of civil defense. A quick Google search will provide you with local activist groups and protests in which you can participate, as well as national organizations like Nightingale Advocacy. Even resharing an Instagram post about reproductive justice can change minds. Whether or not you agree with the morality of abortion, reproductive rights are ultimately an aspect of universal healthcare. By protecting these rights, we can also preserve empathy and the core values of a radiant nation that our Founding Fathers envisioned.



Caption: The once-iconic pink Jackson Women's Health Organization facility is now painted white and remodeled into a luxury consignment store in Fondren, MS.

Gao, Crystal. A photograph of Hunt in Fondren. 17 September 2025.



Caption: The photo above depicts the IJAE office's art room, where members gather for community events with colors and creativity.

Gao, Crystal. A photograph of IJAE's creativity room in Jackson. 8 October 2025.



Caption: The image above was taken from IAJE's website, depicting staff members in front of the facility's mural.

From Casa IAJE

"IAJE in the News." Casa IAJE, <https://iaje.us/iaje-in-the-news>

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